

Harrison Bergeron

Kurt Vonnegut, Jr.

Exploring Content and Form

Select any two (2) of the following four (4) questions to answer. Answer each in complete sentences on a separate sheet of paper, taking care to fully support each response. Each question is worth a possible five (5) marks.

1. This story uses dialogue to shape characters. How is each shaped by what is said?
 - Diana Moon Glampers
 - George
 - Harrison
 - Hazel
2. Harrison Bergeron defies the laws of gravity and motion when liberated from his handicaps. What might Vonnegut be suggesting about the potential of free humans?
3. In traditional stories, the hero is a superhuman figure, superior to ordinary people. Typically, the hero "saves" people from an enemy. In what passages is Harrison superhuman? How are the results of Harrison's efforts an ironic reversal of what happens in traditional heroic stories?
4. Do you think Diana Moon Glampers is "handicapped"? If yes, how? If no, why not?

Deep Thoughts

Select any one (1) of the following two (2) questions to answer. Answer each in a well-structured and supported paragraph on a separate sheet of paper. Embed quotations, where possible, to better support your response. Each is worth a possible ten (10) marks.

1. How do schools behave like the United States Handicapper General office?
2. Why do you think Vonnegut wrote this story?